

New England

Massachusetts · New Hampshire · Rhode Island · Connecticut · Port: Boston

New England has rocky soil, so farms are small. But the sea is full of fish. People dry and salt the fish so it keeps.

Tall trees give wood for ships. You have 7 ships. That is your big strength. Two regions have no ships. They must pay someone to carry their goods.

Rum is made in a **distillery** (a place that makes strong drinks). Rum comes from **molasses** (a syrup left over from making sugar). Molasses comes from the West Indies. Game rule: hold 2 molasses before you trade 1 rum. That is your big problem.

Here is a hard truth. The molasses was made by **enslaved** people (people forced to work for no pay). Some New England ships took rum to Africa. They traded it for captured people. They carried those people across the ocean by force. That trip is the **Middle Passage**.

You have: fish, whale oil, lumber, rum, and 7 ships.

WORDS TO KNOW

Distillery

A place that makes rum from molasses.

Molasses

A thick brown syrup left over when sugar is made.

Enslaved / Slavery

An enslaved person was owned by another person. They were forced to work for no pay. They could not leave. We say enslaved person because they were people first.

The Middle Passage

The Middle Passage was the trip across the ocean from Africa to the Americas. Captured African people were forced onto ships. They were chained and crowded. Many died. The people who lived were sold and enslaved.

Export / Import

Export = send goods out to sell. Import = bring goods in to buy.

Raw Materials

Things from nature, like wood, fish, and crops, before they are made into something.

Naval Stores

Sticky tar from pine trees. Ships need it to keep water out.

NEW ENGLAND IN THE GAME

Starts with 7 Dried Fish, 3 Whale Oil, 5 Lumber, 6 Rum

Ships Owns 7 ships.

Middle Colonies

New York · New Jersey · Pennsylvania · Delaware · Port: Philadelphia

The Middle Colonies have rich farmland. Farmers grow lots of wheat. They grow more than they can eat! This area is called the breadbasket. It grows food for others.

There are many cattle too. Traders get furs from Native Americans. Furs sell for a lot in England.

You have 2 ships.

Your big strength is food. Everyone needs food! Your big problem is that food is cheap and heavy. So try two steps. Trade wheat for sugar in the West Indies. Then trade the sugar to England.

Here is a hard truth. Your wheat fed the sugar islands. There, **enslaved** people (people forced to work for no pay) grew the sugar. They were taken from Africa by force. Ships carried them across the ocean. That trip is the **Middle Passage**. Slavery was legal here too. Many enslaved people lived in New York City.

You have: wheat and grains, lumber, cattle, furs, and 2 ships.

WORDS TO KNOW

Enslaved / Slavery

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The Middle Passage

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Export / Import

Export = send goods out to sell. Import = bring goods in to buy.

Raw Materials

Things from nature, like wood, fish, and crops, before they are made into something.

Cash Crop

A crop grown to sell, not to eat. Tobacco is one.

Monopoly

When you are the **ONLY** one who has something to sell.

MIDDLE COLONIES IN THE GAME

Starts with 7 Wheat & Grains, 7 Lumber, 5 Cattle, 7 Furs

Ships Owns 2 ships.

Southern Colonies

Maryland · Virginia · N. Carolina · S. Carolina · Georgia · Port: Charleston

The Southern Colonies grow tobacco. It is a **cash crop** (a crop grown to sell). They grow so much that England pays very little for it. They also grow rice and **indigo** (a plant that makes blue dye). Pine trees give **naval stores** (tar that keeps ships from leaking).

You have 8 kinds of goods. That is more than anyone! That is your big strength.

Your big problem: you have NO ships. You must pay another region to carry your goods. Or you can trade for a ship of your own.

Who did the work? **Enslaved** African people (people forced to work for no pay). They planted and picked the crops. They could not leave. Many were taken from Africa by force. Ships carried them across the ocean. That trip is called the **Middle Passage**. Many people died on it.

You have: tobacco, rice, naval stores, fish, lumber, furs, silk, indigo. No ships.

WORDS TO KNOW

Cash Crop

A crop grown to sell, not to eat. Tobacco is one.

Indigo

A plant that makes blue dye for cloth.

Naval Stores

Sticky tar from pine trees. Ships need it to keep water out.

Enslaved / Slavery

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The Middle Passage

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Duty

A tax on goods that come in by ship.

Mercantilism

The idea that colonies are there to make the home country rich.

SOUTHERN COLONIES IN THE GAME

Starts with 7 Tobacco, 4 Rice, 5 Naval Stores, 1 Dried Fish, 4 Lumber, 2 Furs, 2 Silk, 3 Indigo

Ships None. This region has to hire a ship from another region.

West Indies

Jamaica · Barbados · Antigua · St. Kitts · Port: Kingston

The West Indies are warm islands in the Caribbean Sea. Sugar cane grows well here. Sugar is worth a lot of money everywhere. That is your big strength.

Making sugar leaves a thick brown syrup called **molasses**. New England buys it to make rum. You have citrus fruit too, like limes and oranges.

Enslaved African people (people forced to work for no pay) grew the sugar. The work was hard and dangerous. Most people on the islands were enslaved. They were taken from Africa by force. Ships carried them across the ocean. That trip is called the **Middle Passage**. This was cruel and wrong.

Your big problem: the islands grow almost nothing else. Even food must come from other places. And you have NO ships. You must pay another region to carry your goods. Or you can trade for a ship.

You have: sugar, molasses, citrus fruit. No ships.

WORDS TO KNOW

Molasses

A thick brown syrup left over when sugar is made.

Enslaved / Slavery

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The Middle Passage

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Cash Crop

A crop grown to sell, not to eat. Tobacco is one.

Monopoly

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WEST INDIES IN THE GAME

Starts with 4 Citrus Fruit, 9 Sugar, 15 Molasses

Ships None. This region has to hire a ship from another region.

England

The Mother Country · Port: London

You play England. England rules the colonies, so it is called the **Mother Country**. It made the trade rules. The colonies had to sell many goods only to England.

England's shops make **manufactured goods** (things made by workers), like guns and tools. The colonies must buy them from you. That is your big strength. You also have the most ships: 8. Other teams may pay you to carry their goods.

Your big problem: you need more items than anyone else. You must trade with the colonies to get them.

English ships also carried people. They took cloth and guns to Africa. They traded them for captured African people. Then the ships carried those people across the ocean by force. That trip is the **Middle Passage**. In the Americas, the people were sold. They were **enslaved** (forced to work for no pay). The ships came home with sugar and tobacco. Two English towns, Liverpool and Bristol, got rich.

You have: guns, gunpowder, clothing, fine furniture, tools, books, silver, and 8 ships.

WORDS TO KNOW

Mother Country

The country that rules the colonies. For us, that is England.

Manufactured Goods

Things made by workers in shops, like tools, guns, and books.

Enslaved / Slavery

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The Middle Passage

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Mercantilism

The idea that colonies are there to make the home country rich.

Duty

A tax on goods that come in by ship.

Monopoly

When you are the **ONLY** one who has something to sell.

ENGLAND IN THE GAME

Starts with 4 Guns, 4 Gunpowder, 2 Clothing, 2 Fine Furniture, 3 Tools, 3 Books, 2 Silver

Ships Owns 8 ships.